

STAGE TWO • PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY & PERSONAL BRAND

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • Adaptation Notes

Stage Two • Professional Identity & Personal Brand

PURPOSE

Stage Two includes more genuinely hands-on, device-dependent activities than Stage One — live LinkedIn editing, website building, photo-taking, on-camera recording — which makes format adaptation more consequential here, not less.

This document covers every activity across Stage Two's Session Plan and Group Versions of Key Exercises documents that genuinely changes shape between formats. A few activities in this stage (notably the Professional Headshot) work meaningfully better in one format than the other; where that's true, it's flagged explicitly rather than pretending both formats are equivalent.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Practice Circle (FIRST B1)	Two concentric circles of chairs, physically rotating after each pair.	Breakout rooms of 2, closed and reopened 4-5 times with new random pairing each round (“re-shuffle breakouts” feature). Post the prompt in chat each round.
Stranger Test (FIRST B3, B8)	Pairs turn to face each other directly.	Breakout rooms of 2. Since paraphrasing quality is easy to fudge in person out of politeness, consider having Partner B type their paraphrase in chat before saying it aloud, which produces more honest first attempts.
Outside-In Panel (FIRST B9)	Groups of 4 physically write answers on paper or index cards, flipping simultaneously.	Use a shared poll or form (submitted but not visible until the facilitator reveals) rather than chat, since chat submissions are visible in real time and bias later answers toward earlier ones.
LinkedIn Profile, Website, Portfolio live-building (B13, B17, B18)	Participants work on personal laptops; facilitator circulates the room for individual troubleshooting.	Share screen briefly to demo the exact steps live before independent work begins. Keep a facilitator or co-facilitator available in the main room continuously for tech troubleshooting via chat, since remote participants can't just raise a hand for a passerby.
Professional Headshot (FIRST B19)	Use a designated well-lit corner of the room, or step outside briefly.	This genuinely works better in person. For a fully remote session, ask participants to take their photos before the session using their own natural light setup at home, and bring 2-3 options to review rather than shooting live on camera.
Fishbowl Role-Play (FIRST B23, from Group Versions doc)	Volunteers sit in a visible inner circle; observers surround them.	Volunteers turn cameras on and unmute; everyone else stays muted with cameras optional. Use the “spotlight” feature so the volunteers' video tiles are prominent for observers.
Recording exercises (FIRST B26, B27)	Participants step to a quiet corner or hallway to record on their phone.	These work naturally well online since participants are already on camera — have them record locally on their device rather than screen-recording the video call, which often has worse audio and lighting.
Full-group share-outs / closing rounds	Genuine round-robin around the room.	Use “raise hand” or call names directly from a list rather than open-floor, which tends to stall on video.

For hands-on building sessions (Session 3 especially), a hybrid format genuinely strains facilitator bandwidth — troubleshooting a remote participant's website builder over chat while also circulating an in-person room is difficult for one facilitator alone. If running Session 3 hybrid, strongly consider a co-facilitator dedicated to the remote participants.

For the Professional Headshot (B19), a hybrid session should treat remote and in-person participants differently rather than forcing one shared method — in-person participants can use the room's best light on the spot, remote participants should bring pre-taken options from home.